LABEEB SLAITEEN

Business Mentor and Coach | Entrepreneurship and Employability Trainer
Agricultural Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Business Mentor and Coach at Caritas Syria (RESTORE 2024-2025, RELINK 2026-present) and Agricultural Engineer, focused on adult training and business development services (BDS). CEFE-trained facilitator (150-hour ToT, Caritas Syria) who also completed the ILO SIYB Training of Trainers (GYB, SYB and IYB packages, 2026). Delivered 8 training cohorts to 168 participants in 2024-2026: 6 cohorts of CEFE-based entrepreneurship training (132 beneficiaries) and 2 cohorts of a 5-day Employability and Life Skills training (36 fresh graduates), using experiential, participatory methods.

Experienced in individual business coaching for business plan preparation and grant readiness, market surveys, beneficiary registration and field monitoring, and electronic data entry in Kobo Toolbox and Excel. Designed and recorded a 6-module online course on oyster mushroom cultivation. Manage a small oyster mushroom farm as a personal project and work as a paid consultant on mushroom farm set-up.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Business Mentor and Coach

Caritas Syria, RELINK Livelihood Project | Latakia, Syria | 06/2026 - Present

Re-hired by Caritas Syria for this project after the RESTORE project closed.

- Deliver a new 5-day, full-time Employability and Life Skills training to fresh graduates of engineering faculties: 2 cohorts to date in Jableh and Latakia (18 participants each), covering self-awareness and values, job search, ATS-friendly CVs, job interviews, negotiation, teamwork, creative thinking, problem solving and decision-making.
- Responsible, within the project's livelihood tracks, for delivering Business Development Skills (BDS) training to grant beneficiaries and GYB training (after completing the SIYB Training of Trainers), providing individual coaching, and accompanying beneficiaries through grant receipt, market purchases and follow-up.
- Handle cash advances for training expenses, and apply accountability, confidentiality and safeguarding principles in all training activities.

Business Mentor and Coach

Caritas Syria, RESTORE Livelihood Project | Latakia, Syria | 06/2024 - 12/2025

- Trained 132 beneficiaries in 6 cohorts of CEFE-based Business Development Skills training (5-day intensive program, about 40 training hours per cohort).
- Provided individual business coaching through repeated follow-up sessions, from business plan preparation and grant readiness to post-selection follow-up.
- Conducted field monitoring, verification and beneficiary follow-up for small and micro business grants, working with community committees.
- Monitored and followed up 267 livelihood project participants.
- Conducted area-based needs assessments with the project team in the rural municipalities of Basta and Kemen; contributed to market needs assessments and took part in labor market assessments and employer visits in Latakia to identify vacancies and on-the-job training opportunities for youth.
- Followed up technical training for 111 rural beneficiaries in mushroom cultivation, poultry raising, medicinal and aromatic plants cultivation, fertilizer production and food processing.
- Linked 3 of the 25 internship beneficiaries in Latakia with private businesses where they trained, and followed them up regularly until the end of the internship.
- Accompanied grant beneficiaries as their mentor from bank receipt of their business grants to the purchase of project equipment, and prepared purchase requests and field transport invoices for the project team.
- Entered beneficiary data, business plans and periodic follow-up records electronically in Kobo Toolbox and Excel.

Online Instructor - Oyster Mushroom Cultivation Course

Freelance work | Remote | 04/2025 - Present

- Designed and recorded a 6-module online course on oyster mushroom cultivation, built on field experience running a mushroom farm.
- Turned technical know-how into structured lessons and practical guides that help learners start small-scale mushroom production for self-employment and income.

Owner, Oyster Mushroom Micro-Farm and Freelance Agricultural Consultant

Self-employed | Latakia, Syria | 06/2016 - Present

- Run a seasonal oyster mushroom micro-farm in the home village (1-2 production seasons a year) for small-scale local production, first started in 2016 while still a student.

- Paid freelance consultant on demand since 2025 in oyster mushroom farm set-up: established and supervised 3 small farms, including 2 set up and cultivated between 02/2026 and 05/2026, and provide remote consultations.
- Before 2025, gave free agricultural advice as a volunteer to community members, mainly on setting up mushroom farms.

Oyster Mushroom Cultivation Trainer (Volunteer)
IECD - European Institute for Cooperation and Development | Latakia, Syria | 01/2024

- Delivered a 5-day practical training on sustainable oyster mushroom cultivation to 38 beneficiaries as a volunteer, including preparation of materials and tools.
- Followed up with trainees remotely via WhatsApp for two months after the training.

HSE Agricultural Supervisor (Part-time)
Syriatel Mobile Telecom | Latakia, Syria | 04/2016 - 01/2017

- Supervised a 19-dunum orchard with about 430 citrus trees, while studying agricultural engineering (horticulture).
- Followed up agricultural operations, guided field workers on proper practices, and supported compliance with occupational safety and environmental requirements.

EDUCATION

Master in Agronomy (ongoing)
Latakia University | Latakia, Syria | 2023 - Present

- Thesis: substrate supplementation for oyster mushroom production; research completed in 2026, final defense pending.

Bachelor in Agricultural Engineering, Horticulture
Latakia University (formerly Tishreen University) | Latakia, Syria | 2013 - 2019

CERTIFICATIONS AND TRAINING

- Start and Improve Your Business (SIYB) Training of Trainers (ToT) - ILO | Caritas Syria | 10/2026 - 11/2026 | GYB, SYB and IYB packages, Damascus
- Business Development Skills Training of Trainers (ToT) - CEFE | Caritas Syria | 04/2024 - 09/2024 | 150 hours, including a supervised training practicum
- Project Management: Life Cycle and Project Planning | Politecnico di Milano via Coursera | 01/2025
- Working for a Sustainable Future: Concepts and Approaches | Lund University via Coursera | 09/2024
- Humanitarian Assistance: Adapting to Urban Challenges | IFRC / German Red Cross | 08/2024 | 8 modules
- Agricultural Supervision Certificate | Syriatel Mobile Telecom | 04/2016 - 01/2017

CORE SKILLS

Training and Facilitation: experiential adult learning, CEFE methodology, ILO SIYB methodology (GYB, SYB, IYB), entrepreneurship training, employability skills training, online course design

Business Development Services: business coaching and mentoring, business plan preparation, grant application readiness

Livelihoods Implementation: training delivery, beneficiary registration and follow-up, field monitoring, needs assessments, market and labor market surveys, employer visits

Project and Grant Support: beneficiary data entry and follow-up records, cash advances for training expenses, grant follow-up

Data and Office Tools: proficient in Microsoft Office (Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Outlook), Kobo Toolbox

Agriculture and Soft Skills: horticulture, oyster mushroom production, sustainable agriculture, drip irrigation, communication, adaptability, teamwork, problem solving

LANGUAGES

Arabic: Native | English: Good professional working proficiency (written and spoken)